

TELL ME WHY
RESPIRATORY SYNCYTIAL VIRUS IS HIGHLY CONTAGIOUS
Dr Feroza Dawood, Obstetrician and Gynecologist, explains

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WEEKEND EDITION

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DXB to achieve 100m traveller target by 2026

MILESTONE PASSENGER VOLUME WAS PREVIOUSLY FORECAST FOR 2027

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Dubai International Airport (DXB) aims to achieve a record-breaking milestone of 100 million passengers sooner than anticipated, with revised projections now targeting 2026 instead of 2027. According to Dubai Airports CEO Paul Griffiths, the accelerated growth follows at least three upward forecast revisions in 2024, fuelled by strong passenger traffic.

“We revised our forecast at least thrice in an upward direction last year. I think that’s giving us the confidence to suggest that we might end up reaching 100 million earlier,” Griffiths told *Gulf News*.

“The forecast for 2025 is around 94 million plus, and 2026, at the moment, we’re saying 98, but I wouldn’t mind betting our 100 million forecast for 2027 may be brought forward into 2026,” Griffiths stated.

Griffiths’ comments follow Dubai Airports’ announcement of its 2024 passenger traffic figures, revealing that the world’s busiest hub for international travel handled a record 92.3 million passengers, marking a nearly 6 per cent year-on-year increase.

Griffiths said concerns remain over the surrounding infrastructure’s ability to support this rapid growth despite the robust outlook. “One of our biggest concerns is whether the road and rail system around us can cope with this level of traffic,” he said.

‘Airport of the world’

Over the past decade, Dubai International Airport (DXB) has handled more than 700 million passengers on over 3.3 million flights. His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, said in a post yesterday. “Dubai is the airport of the world... and a new world in the aviation sector,” said Shaikh Mohammad.

To meet the rapidly growing demand, the government of Dubai greenlit a \$35 billion plan to expand Dubai’s second airport – Al Maktoum International Airport or Dubai World Central (DEC)

92.3m

passengers handled by Dubai International Airport in 2024

NATION

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WORLD

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THOUSANDS OF GAZANS WITNESS HANDOVER OF HOSTAGES

Gazans crowd around a Red Cross convoy as Palestinian militant group Islamic Jihad and Hamas fighters prepare to hand over two Israeli and five Thai hostages in Khan Younis yesterday as part of their third hostage-prisoner exchange, which also saw 110 Palestinian prisoners freed from Ofer Prison in the occupied West Bank. **SEE ALSO P13**

Check your health with phone camera

Get cholesterol level, heart rate, blood pressure in seconds

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Patients in the UAE will soon be able to check their vital health indicators instantly using their smartphone instead of visiting a lab thanks to an AI-powered system announced by the Ministry of Health and Prevention (MoHAP) at Arab Health 2025 in Dubai.

The new technology, called ‘Biosigns’, an innovative arti-

ficial intelligence (AI) system that transforms smartphones and tablets into personal health monitoring devices, promises to transform the way residents track their health.

Real-time readings

Biosigns allows smartphone cameras to measure cholesterol, haemoglobin, heart rate, blood pressure, and even stress levels within seconds. The system, approved by the US Food and Drug Administration (FDA), analyses facial images to detect subtle changes in skin colour and blood flow beneath the skin, providing accurate real-time health readings, according to MoHAP.

The Biosigns technology is designed to make health monitoring more accessible, reducing the need for frequent lab visits and costly medical tests. With results available instantly through a smartphone app or web platform, users can keep track of their health effortlessly.

Unlike traditional devices, which require blood samples or external sensors, Biosigns relies solely on a smartphone camera, making it a convenient and cost-effective alternative. The system is expected to integrate with approved health applications in the UAE, connecting directly to the country’s unified health record system.

Sharaf DG

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